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King hired as next CPS leader

Chicago Board of Education members pose for a selfie with Chicago Public Schools CEO Macquiline King after she was voted in as permanent CEO on Monday.
EILEEN T. MESLAR/CHICAGO TRIBUNE



School board votes to give Chicago Public Schools interim CEO the permanent position

By Kate Armanini
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

The Chicago Board of Education voted Monday to install interim CEO Macquiline King as the district's next permanent leader, tapping a former teacher and principal with deep local roots to helm the nation's fourth-largest school district.

In an 18-1 vote, board members approved a three-year contract for King with a \$380,000 starting salary.

King has led Chicago Public Schools in the interim since June, following the December 2024 firing without cause of CPS CEO Pedro Martinez. She last served as the senior director of education policy in Mayor Brandon Johnson's office.

Addressing the board, King described her life as "a series of chapters written within the walls of Chicago Public Schools." She pledged to center her work around the district's 315,000 students and fiscal stability.

"I know that strong leadership isn't a monologue. It is a conversation, one that we very much started on this floor today," King said. "I will continue to immerse myself

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Trump issues new threat to energy sites

Diplomacy demand comes amid wave of Mideast strikes

By Jon Gambrell, Josh Boak and Mike Corder
ASSOCIATED PRESS

DUBAI, United Arab Emirates — President Donald Trump on Monday threatened widespread destruction of Iran's energy resources and other vital infrastructure, potentially including desalination plants that supply drinking water, if a deal to end the war is not reached "shortly."

Iran meanwhile struck a key water and electrical plant in Kuwait, and an oil refinery in Israel came under attack. Israel and the U.S. launched a new wave of strikes on Iran, as the war raged with no end in sight.

Trump's new threat came in a social media post. Earlier comments to the Financial Times suggested American troops could seize Iran's Kharg Island oil export hub. Trump has repeatedly claimed to be making diplomatic progress — though Tehran denies negotiating directly — while ramping up his threats and sending thousands more U.S. troops to the Middle East.

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Johnson's first chief homelessness officer exits

No replacement named for job meant to be temporary

By Alice Yin
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Mayor Brandon Johnson's first chief homelessness officer appears to be his last, with his inaugural appointee departing the position that the mayor's team said was always meant to be a temporary one.

Sendy Soto will be exiting the administration after two years in the role, with no replacement planned because the position was funded via a philanthropic grant, Johnson's spokesperson Griffin Krueger said in a Monday statement.

The city's five-year blueprint on addressing homelessness, which Krueger said was the main priority of Soto's job, will be publicly released on Tuesday.

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Northbrook mourns teen

The Cook County sheriff's office on Monday continued to investigate the fatal shooting of 16-year-old Lilly Bova over the weekend. Meanwhile, Bova's life loomed over her community, as students at Glenbrook South High School, where Bova was a sophomore, returned to class for the first time after spring break.
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NASA's Space Launch System rocket with the Orion spacecraft is set for the Artemis II mission on Launch Complex 39B at sunrise at Kennedy Space Center on March 24 in Cape Canaveral, Fla. **JOHN RAOUX/AP**

'Humanity's call'

Chicago space expert weighs in on launch of mission to orbit moon



Voula Saridakis, a NASA Solar System ambassador and head curator at the Griffin Museum of Science and Industry in Chicago, stands in the SpaceX Dragon cargo spacecraft exhibition in the Henry Crown Space Center on Feb. 9.
EILEEN T. MESLAR/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

By Christiana Freitag
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

After weeks of delays, four astronauts are preparing to launch Wednesday evening on a trip around the moon, the first such spaceflight to be undertaken in more than 50 years.

"It's really just a historic mission for the future Artemis missions, but also to prepare us for the human journey to Mars and further space exploration," said Voula Saridakis, National Aeronautics and Space Administration Solar System ambassador. "So it has this wider purpose, if you will."

As head curator of the Griffin Museum of Science and Industry, Saridakis is also preparing to bring the celebration of this historic space launch to Chicago — offering residents and visitors an opportunity to experience history firsthand.

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